

How to Apply for PIP with Fibromyalgia in the UK

Practical NHS-backed advice on how to apply for pip with fibromyalgia uk.

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How to Apply for PIP with Fibromyalgia in the UK

Quick Answer: To apply for PIP with fibromyalgia, call the DWP on 0800 917 2222 to start your claim, then complete the PIP2 form focusing on how fibromyalgia affects your ability to carry out daily activities and mobility on your worst days. Medical evidence from your GP is essential.

Fibromyalgia is a recognised condition for PIP purposes. Despite being an "invisible" illness, fibromyalgia's effects on daily activities can score sufficient points for PIP. Focus on functional impact, not just your diagnosis.

Understanding PIP Criteria

PIP is assessed on how your condition affects your ability to carry out 10 daily living activities and 2 mobility activities — not on your diagnosis itself. For fibromyalgia, the key activities include preparing food, washing and bathing, dressing, managing medications, and engaging with others.

Daily Activities Most Affected by Fibromyalgia

- Preparing and cooking food (fatigue, pain, cognitive fog)
 - Washing and bathing (pain, fatigue)
 - Dressing and undressing (joint pain, stiffness)
 - Managing medications and making decisions (fibro fog)
 - Engaging with other people (social anxiety, fatigue)
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The Application Process



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Call the DWP's PIP claims line (0800 917 2222) to start your claim. They will send you a PIP2 form to complete within 30 days. Describe your worst days, not your best. Be specific about time taken to complete activities — if it takes much longer than average, this scores points.

If You're Refused

Around 50% of initial PIP decisions are successfully overturned on appeal. Always request a Mandatory Reconsideration first (within one month), then appeal to a tribunal if still refused. Citizens Advice offers free help with appeals.

Q&A;



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Question: Is fibromyalgia automatically accepted for PIP? **Short answer:** No — PIP is not diagnosis-based. However, fibromyalgia's effects on daily activities can score sufficient points. Focus on functional impact, not just your diagnosis.

Question: How much is PIP worth? **Short answer:** Daily living pays £72.65 or £108.55 per week. Mobility pays £28.70 or £75.75 per week (2024/25 rates). You may receive one or both components.

Question: Can I get help filling in the PIP form? **Short answer:** Yes — Citizens Advice (0800 144 8848) and local welfare rights services offer free form-filling support. The way you describe your condition makes a significant difference to the outcome.